

Bell Peppers Information Pack

Introduction

Our Bell Peppers are grown in Chichester, West Sussex.

Situated on a disused airfield, this second-generation family business is one of the largest and most efficient producers of Capsicum in the UK. In their 100 acres of glasshouses, they plant out up to 1 million pepper plants across a range of varieties at the beginning of the season. Using natural season extension techniques, they can then supply UK peppers of incredible quality for the majority of the year, reducing reliance on imports.



Farm Information

Unfortunately, the UK does not have the same climate as Southern Italy, or Central America, therefore we have to use modern agricultural techniques to grow this crop.

A common technique of season extensions involves heating the glasshouse to stimulate plant growth, which can be an environmentally dubious and costly process. To sidestep this, our growers have invested heavily in their very own energy generation plant. This burns natural gas to produce electricity for the National Grid, the waste heat and CO2 is then recycled via a catalytic converter and syphoned into the glasshouses to accentuate plant growth, utilizing this otherwise discarded emission from the energy generation process. This dedication to sustainable food production at scale is one of the many reasons that we love working with this grower.

Furthermore, they have pushed the boundaries of innovation in the area of Integrated Pest Management. In glasshouse growing pests can be a real problem. They sneak in through the air vents and can cause havoc, reducing the crop to a worthless state in days. Formerly, growers were obliged to spray they crop with a cocktail of noxious chemicals designed to kill off every creepy crawly before they can get a foothold. However, modern developments in pest management have birthed a more natural approach, by actively introducing 'good pests' that naturally hunt 'bad pests' the grower can pack up the expensive and potentially harmful chemicals and let nature take care of the rest, a win-win.

More

To feed a growing population with fresh and delicious UK produce, we must encourage growers such as this to continue to push the boundaries of innovation into sustainable

food production, season extension and natural pest management techniques at SCALE, producing food that is available to all.

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